ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 19: **Dust of Snow (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** Robert Frost	An American poet.
2	**(b)** sorrow and poison	Its name evokes poison.
3	**(c)** contrast of white snow and black crow	Imagery of colours.
4	**(a)** regret and gloom	He had been regretting the day.
5	**(a)** a small, unexpected natural event	A tiny incident.
6	**(b)** simple vocabulary	Easy words.
7	**(d)** crow	A black bird.
8	**(a)** nature can lift our spirits	Small things matter.
9	**(d)** lyric poetry	Short personal poem.
10	**(d)** hemlock tree	A conifer.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The poet himself speaks (1) and he is sad and regretful about the day (1).	1+1
12	Both are linked with gloom (1) yet they bring joy here (1).	1+1
13	The snow that falls is light like dust (1) and it is the cause of the mood change (1).	1+1
14	It shook the snow off the hemlock tree (1) and the powder fell on the poet (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He was gloomy (1). He regretted the day (1). He felt no cheer (1).	1+1+1
16	A shift of feeling (1). From regret to ease (1). Caused by the snow (1).	1+1+1
17	crow-snow (1). me-tree (1). heart-part and mood-rued (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The snow fell on him suddenly (1). It startled him pleasantly (1). His mood was lifted (1).	1+1+1
18	Short words (1). Direct images (1). Quiet music of rhyme (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It is a metaphor (1). Snow is compared to dust (1). It shows lightness (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	A small incident changes a mood (1). Crow and hemlock (1). Snow falls on the poet (1). He feels cheered (1). Message of hope (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Address and date (1). Greeting (1). The moment (1). Feelings (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	The poet is sad (1). A crow shakes snow (1). It falls on him (1). His mood changes (1). The day is partly saved (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Both are short (1). Nature as active (1). Crow vs cat (1). Mood vs scene (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Taking 'crow' and 'hemlock' as symbols of good luck; they are traditionally **ill omens**, yet the dust of snow lifts the poet's mood: that is the contrast.
- Writing that the hemlock is the poisonous plant; here it is a **hemlock tree** (a conifer), so avoid calling it poison.
- Giving the wrong change of mood: the poet was in **regret and gloom**; the shower of snow saved part of his day, a tiny incident with a big effect.
- Mixing the device: 'the way a crow shook down on me the dust of snow' uses *imagery and simple language*; there is no simile in it.
- Ignoring the rhyme scheme **abab** (crow-snow, me-tree) and the poem's two short stanzas of four lines each.
- Spelling slips: *hemlock, rued, crow, Robert Frost, mood*; and 'rued' meaning regretted.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 19: **Dust of Snow (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** abab cdcd	Alternate lines rhyme.
2	**(d)** state of mind	Feeling.
3	**(b)** a light dusting of snow	Fine snow.
4	**(c)** crow - snow	Crow and snow.
5	**(a)** The snow was shaken by the crow.	Past passive.
6	**(b)** mood	A change of mood.
7	**(c)** light and tiny particles	Fine snow.
8	**(a)** cheer	Gloom x cheer.
9	**(c)** two stanzas of four lines	Eight lines in all.
10	**(a)** a moment that changes a mood	A small moment.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A small natural event lifts his heart (1) showing nature's healing power (1).	1+1
12	Calm and gently reflective (1) with a hint of cheer at the end (1).	1+1
13	It changed his mood (1) and brightened his heart (1).	1+1
14	Two quatrains (1) with the rhyme scheme abab cdcd (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The crow is a bird of ill omen (1). The hemlock is linked with poison and sorrow (1). Their effect is the opposite of expectation, which is ironic (1).	1+1+1
16	People regret the day's events (1). They can be relieved by small joys (1). Regret need not rule us (1).	1+1+1
17	He rued his hasty words (1). Her mood was cheerful (1). Both words are used correctly (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Black crow and white snow (1). Gloom and cheer (1). Expectation and reality (1).	1+1+1
18	Two stanzas (1). First sets the incident (1). Second gives the effect (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Cheer up (1). Notice small joys (1). Nature can help (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Colours of black and white (1). Crow as symbol (1). Hemlock as sorrow (1). Snow as purity (1). Effect (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Theme (1). Imagery (1). Rhyme (1). Tone (1). Personal view (1).	2+2+1
20	Gentle action (1). Quick change (1). Poet's response (1). Everyday example (1). Message (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Crow and hemlock suggest gloom (1). Snow lifts mood (1). Irony (1). Message (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Taking 'crow' and 'hemlock' as symbols of good luck; they are traditionally **ill omens**, yet the dust of snow lifts the poet's mood: that is the contrast.
- Writing that the hemlock is the poisonous plant; here it is a **hemlock tree** (a conifer), so avoid calling it poison.
- Giving the wrong change of mood: the poet was in **regret and gloom**; the shower of snow saved part of his day, a tiny incident with a big effect.
- Mixing the device: 'the way a crow shook down on me the dust of snow' uses *imagery and simple language*; there is no simile in it.
- Ignoring the rhyme scheme **abab** (crow-snow, me-tree) and the poem's two short stanzas of four lines each.
- Spelling slips: *hemlock, rued, crow, Robert Frost, mood*; and 'rued' meaning regretted.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 19: **Dust of Snow (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** on	Fell on.
2	**(c)** regretted	To feel sorry.
3	**(b)** wasted by sadness	He regretted it.
4	**(d)** remorse	Sorrow.
5	**(a)** quietly hopeful	The mood lifts.
6	**(b)** part of the day	A part.
7	**(c)** a trivial incident can bring cheer	Moods can shift quickly.
8	**(d)** bad omen	Traditionally gloomy.
9	**(c)** first person	He uses 'me'.
10	**(d)** dejected	Low spirits.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Small joys can lift sorrow (1) and one should not lose hope (1).	1+1
12	The poet had been regretting the day (1) but the incident saved a part of it from sadness (1).	1+1
13	They can change suddenly (1) with a tiny incident (1).	1+1
14	Robert Frost (1) an American poet (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	A tiny event changes his heart (1). Nature heals without effort (1). We must be open to it (1).	1+1+1
16	Freshness and purity (1). A gift of nature (1). A turning point (1).	1+1+1
17	Soft sounds (1). Quiet images (1). A turn at the end (1).	1+1+1
	OR: They state the effect (1). They show the day is partly saved (1). They give a note of hope (1).	1+1+1
18	Appreciative (1). Receptive (1). Grateful (1).	1+1+1
	OR: People still feel low (1). Small joys help (1). It is short and sweet (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Introduction (1). Poem's example (1). Personal examples (1). Explanation (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Poem (1). Examples (1). Benefits (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Date (1). Gloomy morning (1). The crow and snow (1). Change of mood (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: First person (1). On the tree (1). Shaking the snow (1). Seeing the man (1). Result (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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- Writing that the hemlock is the poisonous plant; here it is a **hemlock tree** (a conifer), so avoid calling it poison.
- Giving the wrong change of mood: the poet was in **regret and gloom**; the shower of snow saved part of his day, a tiny incident with a big effect.
- Mixing the device: 'the way a crow shook down on me the dust of snow' uses *imagery and simple language*; there is no simile in it.
- Ignoring the rhyme scheme **abab** (crow-snow, me-tree) and the poem's two short stanzas of four lines each.
- Spelling slips: *hemlock, rued, crow, Robert Frost, mood*; and 'rued' meaning regretted.

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